

Ten ways the logo could go

Ten *directions*, not ten drafts of one idea. They disagree with each other on purpose. The useful thing to send back is which one you would put on a van — not which drawing you like best.

WHAT I WORKED FROM

Full-service IT for small and mid-size businesses across the northwest suburbs, going since 1996 — networks, servers, PCs and phone systems, for legal, non-profit, medical and home-office clients.

That came off public listings, not from you. Correct any of it and the drawings change.

I have also not seen the logo you dislike — arcane-computing.com would not load from where I was working. So these are drawn against the brief, not against its faults.



01
SEAL



02
KEYSTONE



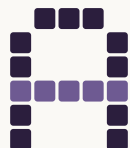
03
ASTROLABE



04
WARD



05
TRACE



06
CIPHER



07
ALEMBIC



08
HEX



09
BEACON



10
PILLAR

EVERY PAGE

the lockup, light and dark

AT SIZE

52 down to 16 pixels

ONE COLOUR

for vinyl, etching and embroidery

PALETTE

three colours, never more

AND

the idea, and what could go wrong with it



ARCANE
C O M P U T I N G



ARCANE
C O M P U T I N G



MARK ALONE

AT SIZE



52 px



32 px



20 px



16 px

ONE COLOUR



PALETTE



Midnight
#14162E



Brass
#9A7434



Parchment
#F4F1EA

THE IDEA

Arcane is a gift of a name and this is the direction that spends it. A seal is what a firm puts on work it stands behind; the A sits inside it as a rune of three strokes and three nodes, which is also a network diagram if you squint.

WATCH OUT FOR

Roman caps carry authority, but they carry law office with them. If a client reads a notary stamp before they read an IT company, that is this one failing.



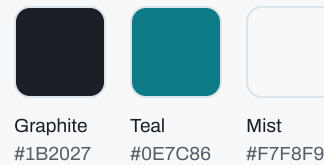
AT SIZE



ONE COLOUR



PALETTE



THE IDEA

The flat-topped A is a keystone: the one stone an arch cannot lose. That is the whole pitch for an IT provider, stated as a shape, with no wizardry asked of the viewer.

WATCH OUT FOR

It is the safest of the ten and so the most forgettable. A solid A in a rounded tile is a shape a hundred other companies already own.



ARCANE

C O M P U T I N G



ARCANE

C O M P U T I N G



MARK ALONE

AT SIZE



52 px



32 px



20 px



16 px

ONE COLOUR



PALETTE



Navy
#0E1B33



Gold
#96731A



Chalk
#F1F3F7

THE IDEA

A star chart and a network topology are the same drawing: dots joined by lines. This is the only direction where arcane and computing stop being a pun and become one picture.

WATCH OUT FOR

The ring and its ticks are the first thing to go below about 22 pixels, so it ships with the simplified mark shown here. Two drawings to keep straight instead of one.



ARCANE

C O M P U T I N G



ARCANE

C O M P U T I N G



MARK ALONE

AT SIZE



52 px



32 px



20 px



16 px

ONE COLOUR



PALETTE



Vault
#10352C



Copper
#A75C28



Bone
#F2EFE7

THE IDEA

A ward is the part of a lock a wrong key cannot pass. The vault holds a keyhole and a single circuit trace runs out of it, which is the thing legal and medical clients are actually buying from you.

WATCH OUT FOR

Shield-and-keyhole is the most crowded corner of IT branding. The trace and the flat-topped shield make it yours, but it starts from a common noun.



MARK ALONE

AT SIZE



52 px



32 px



20 px



16 px

ONE COLOUR



PALETTE

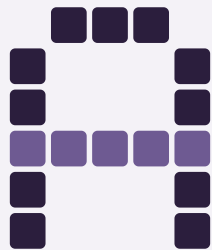
Ink
#101112Vermilion
#C23B24Paper
#F5F4F0

THE IDEA

One wire, one via. The name is set in the typeface the work is done in, so the mark is free to be almost nothing and the lockup still says computing out loud.

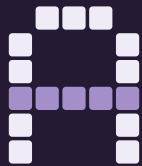
WATCH OUT FOR

Mono type reads startup, and the company has been going since 1996. Thirty years is an asset this direction spends rather than banks.



ARCANE

C O M P U T I N G



ARCANE

C O M P U T I N G



MARK ALONE

AT SIZE



52 px



32 px



20 px



16 px

ONE COLOUR



PALETTE



Violet
#2B1E3D



Amethyst
#6E5A92



Quartz
#F4F2F7

THE IDEA

Arcane means encoded. The A is built on a grid of blocks, so the mark is the letter drawn the way a machine would draw it, and the grid is its own argument for why it still works at 16 pixels.

WATCH OUT FOR

Bitmap marks date to a decade. Read as a deliberate nod to 1996 it is charming; read wrong it is a company that never updated anything.



ARCANE
C O M P U T I N G



ARCANE
C O M P U T I N G



MARK ALONE

AT SIZE



52 px



32 px



20 px



16 px

ONE COLOUR



PALETTE



Oxblood
#6B2434



Gold
#8A6A24



Parchment
#F6F1E8

THE IDEA

The one direction that takes the name literally: alchemy, not fantasy. A vessel drawn in two arcs and three lines, with the gold sitting in the bottom of it.

WATCH OUT FOR

It says laboratory before it says network, and a flask is a chemistry mark in most people's heads. Highest character of the ten, and the highest risk.



ARCANE
C O M P U T I N G



ARCANE
C O M P U T I N G



MARK ALONE

AT SIZE



52 px



32 px



20 px



16 px

ONE COLOUR



PALETTE



Steel
#3B4654



Rust
#B4501F



Vapor
#F2F4F6

THE IDEA

A hexagon is the shape of infrastructure: a nut, a tile, one cell of a mesh. The A is cut clean out of it, so the mark stays one object with nothing stuck on.

WATCH OUT FOR

Hex tiles have been the house style of every cloud and security vendor for a decade. This borrows their credibility and their sameness in the same move.



ARCANE

C O M P U T I N G



ARCANE

C O M P U T I N G



MARK ALONE

AT SIZE



52 px



32 px



20 px



16 px

ONE COLOUR



PALETTE



Deep sea
#0B2A3A



Lamp
#9A6415



Fog
#EFF3F4

THE IDEA

Someone is awake at two in the morning. A lighthouse is the oldest version of that promise, and it puts down to a cap, a lamp and two arcs of light.

WATCH OUT FOR

Nothing in it says computers. It only earns its place if always on, always watching is the story the business actually wants to sell.



MARK ALONE

AT SIZE



52 px



32 px



20 px



16 px

ONE COLOUR



PALETTE

Charcoal
#1C1C1EGraphite
#6E6E69Bone
#F2F0EA

THE IDEA

No picture and no colour. A slab-serif A, set once, with the slabs doing all the work. Cheapest to produce, impossible to date, and it never fights whatever it is printed beside.

WATCH OUT FOR

It asks the name to carry everything. If Arcane Computing does not already mean something to a client, this hands them nothing extra to hold.

01 · CARD

Midnight stock, brass foil or flat ink.



08 · CARD

Uncoated white, one rust rule.



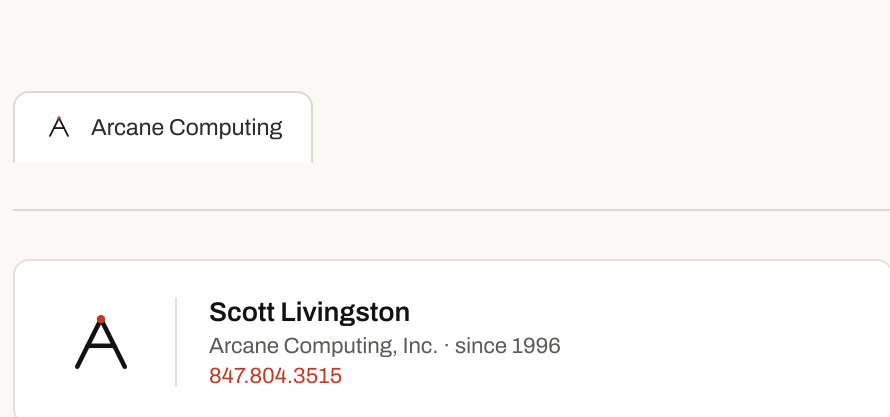
04 · VAN DOOR

Cut vinyl, two colours.



05 · SCREEN

Favicon at 16px, and a signature.



07 · CARD

Oxblood stock, gold edge.



10 · CARD

Letterpress on bone, no colour at all.



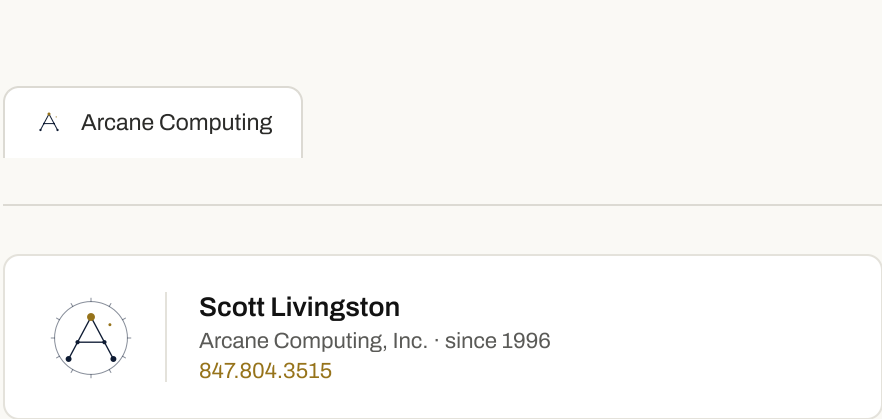
09 · VAN DOOR

Cut vinyl, two colours.



03 · SCREEN

Favicon at 16px, and a signature.



Pick a direction, not a drawing

Refining all ten is how logo projects die. One gets chosen, then it gets the week it deserves: the curves corrected, the spacing set by eye rather than by maths, the wordmark drawn properly instead of typed.

Every mark here is already real vector art on a 120×120 grid, not a generated picture. Nothing needs redrawing between a van door and a tray icon.

01 Say a number, and what is wrong with it

Even “08, but the orange is awful” is enough to work from. Two numbers is fine too — they can be crossed.

02 Correct the brief

If the client mix or the founding year is off, say so. Half of these were drawn to suit law and medical offices specifically.

03 Then it gets built out

Full lockup, stacked and horizontal, one-colour and reversed, favicon set, and a one-page sheet saying how small it may go and what may never be done to it.

04 Files you can hand anyone

SVG and EPS for the sign shop and the embroiderer, PNG at the sizes Windows and the web ask for, and a PDF of this deck.